

Christine Gandiya

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May 11, 2026

Hiring Committee

Computational Mechanisms of Psychopathology Lab

Emory University

Atlanta, GA

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Data Analyst position in the Computational Mechanisms of Psychopathology Lab at Emory University. I am completing a Bachelor of Arts in Psychology and Mathematics-Computer Science at The College of Idaho, with a specialization in Data Science, and will graduate in May 2026. I am especially interested in this position because it combines psychological research, data quality, statistical analysis, reproducible code, and collaborative support for research teams.

My research experience has prepared me to work carefully with real data and connect analyses back to meaningful research questions. In the Development in Academic Settings Lab at The College of Idaho, I serve as a lead Research Assistant on projects grounded in Expectancy-Value Theory. In that role, I have prepared IRB materials, conducted statistical analyses in R using a large-scale dataset, developed research posters, presented findings at virtual and in-person conferences, and contributed to a manuscript in preparation. This experience strengthened my attention to detail, organization, and ability to communicate quantitative findings clearly.

I also bring technical experience that aligns with the data-focused responsibilities of this role. Through coursework and independent projects, I have worked with Python, R, SQL, data cleaning, visualization, regression modeling, classification models, cross-validation, and machine learning workflows. For my sample analysis, I built a reproducible Python project using pandas, scikit-learn, preprocessing pipelines, model comparison, cross-validation, and random forests. While my current background is stronger in behavioral and educational data than neuroimaging, I am comfortable learning new technical tools and would be excited to build experience with neuroimaging, psychophysiological, and passive sensing data in a research lab setting.

Beyond analysis, I enjoy helping others work through technical problems. As a Course Assistant for Data Analysis and Statistics, Applied Calculus, and Survey of Algebra/Probability and Functions, I supported students with quantitative coursework and graded assignments. My IT Helpdesk experience also helped me develop patience, troubleshooting skills, and clear communication when assisting faculty and students with software and technical issues. I would bring that same approach to supporting lab members with data organization, analysis workflows, and reproducible code.

I would be grateful for the opportunity to contribute to COMPLab's research by supporting reliable data management, statistical analysis, visualization, and collaborative technical workflows. Thank you for your time and consideration. I have included my resume and GitHub/sample analysis materials and would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my psychology, statistics, and programming background could support your team.

Sincerely,

Christine Gandiya